

North Star Summit 2026-27: Data Science

Syllabus and schedule · Mr. Hayward · george@haywarddatascience.com

Grade 12 · About six students · Mr. Hayward and two school teachers

All dates are tentative until the school confirms them. Meeting times will be set in Eastern time. We meet about once a month in the fall and about every three weeks from January to March. Most work happens between meetings. We start on October 22, finish Sheets before winter break, start Python in mid-January and present in mid-April.

How it works: Each assignment follows the same pattern: we introduce it at a meeting, you send questions, you turn in your work, and Mr. Hayward sends feedback. School breaks can stretch a cycle.

October to December 2026: Spreadsheets

Assignment or activity	Meeting	Due or feedback
Kickoff: meet Mr. Hayward, see the opening slides and start your own Sheet	Oct 22, 2026	
Assessment week: no course work due		Oct 26 to 30
Submit your goals and first spreadsheet questions through Forms		Nov 5, 2026
Spreadsheet check-in; introduce optional streak and VLOOKUP bonuses	Nov 12, 2026	
First spreadsheet attempt: six answers, formulas and Sheet link		Nov 18, 2026
Mr. Hayward returns feedback on your first attempt		Nov 24, 2026
Send any remaining spreadsheet or bonus questions		Nov 30, 2026
Finish Sheets: six answers, explanations and any optional bonus work	Dec 3, 2026	Dec 3, 2026
Mr. Hayward returns final spreadsheet feedback		Dec 10, 2026

How to submit: Use one personal Google Sheet and one personal Colab notebook all year. For each assignment, open its Google Form while signed in to your school account. Type your answers, paste your code and results where asked, and include the link to your work. Paste the full letter into its Form. The Google Forms confirmation is your receipt. Send questions through the check-in Form. You can resubmit after revisions, and teachers review your latest response.

Breaks: No required course work from December 11 to January 13. We also pause for assessments on October 26 to 30 and January 19 to 22, and for assessments and spring break from March 22 to April 2. Dates avoid school closures and events on the school calendar.

January to April 2027: Python, Gemini and presentations

Assignment or activity	Meeting	Due or feedback
A02: start Python in your own Colab notebook	Jan 14, 2027	Questions: Jan 28
A02: submit six answers, your Python code, results and Colab link		Feb 4, 2027
A03 and A03R: compare weekdays and write a letter to your teacher	Feb 4, 2027	Questions: Feb 11
Mr. Hayward returns A02 feedback		Feb 11, 2027
A03 and A03R: submit your answers, code and full letter (150 to 250 words)		Feb 18, 2027
A04 and A05: histogram and time-series charts; review the weekday work and letters	Feb 25, 2027	A03 and A03R feedback: Feb 25
Send questions about the two chart tasks		Mar 4, 2027
A04 and A05: submit code, charts, results and Colab link		Mar 11, 2027
Gemini workshop: redo one Sheets task and one Python task; review charts	Mar 18, 2027	A04 and A05 feedback: Mar 18
Send Gemini and presentation questions before spring break		Mar 19, 2027
AI: submit your Gemini work, prompts, pros and cons, and two checks. A06: submit a four-slide draft.		Apr 8, 2027
Mr. Hayward returns Gemini and draft feedback		Apr 12, 2027
A06: final presentations; submit your Slides link and reflection	Apr 15, 2027	Apr 15, 2027
Mr. Hayward returns final presentation feedback		Apr 19, 2027

Gemini: In March you will redo one Sheets task and one Python task with Gemini, using only the public course data. You will submit your prompts, what Gemini made, its pros and cons, and two checks of its numbers. If Gemini is not available, a teacher will provide a sample response.

Privacy: The course website has no student login and does not track completion. Your work lives in Google Drive, shared only with you, Mr. Hayward and your two teachers.

Course website: haywarddatascience.com/summit